Leyland Australia Austin 1800 / Utility (Landcrab) (Australia) Specification & Service Refe

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Leyland Australia | Model: Austin 1800 / Utility (Landcrab) | Australian Market Years: 1965-1971
Vehicle Type: 4-door Sedan / 2-door Coupe Utility | Segment: Mid-size / Large | Locally Built: Yes
Assembly Plants (AU): Victoria Park (Zetland), Sydney, New South Wales

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Austin 1800 (BMC project ADO17, affectionately nicknamed the 'Landcrab' for its broad track and tenacious roadholding) was manufactured in Australia by BMC and later Leyland Australia at the Victoria Park assembly complex in Zetland, Sydney. Featuring Alec Issigonis's revolutionary transverse engine front-wheel-drive layout, Hydrolastic interconnected fluid suspension, and an astonishingly spacious passenger cabin with 70% of car length devoted to passengers, the 1800 won Wheels Car of the Year in 1965. Australia made two world-exclusive contributions to the model: Australian engineers re-engineered the shell with elevated ground clearance and sump protection for outback endurance (proven by an astonishing 2nd place in the gruelling 1968 London-to-Sydney Marathon); and in 1968, Leyland Australia designed and manufactured the world's only Austin 1800 Utility ('Landcrab Ute'), combining front-wheel drive, a completely flat load bed, and Hydrolastic self-levelling suspension that kept the ute flat regardless of cargo weight! Over 56,000 Austin 1800s were built in Sydney.

The Australian-developed Austin 1800 Utility was an engineering triumph. Because front-wheel drive eliminated the transmission tunnel and rear differential, the load bed was totally flat with incredible capacity. Combined with the Hydrolastic interconnected suspension, the rear never sagged under load. The 1800 'S' saloon added twin SU carburettors, a sports cam, and 72 kW (96 bhp) performance.

SERIES / GENERATION: Mk-I (Mk I Austin 1800) [1965-1968]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan | ANCAP: None
Wheels Car of the Year 1965. Transverse 1.8L BMC B-series engine, Hydrolastic fluid suspension, front-wheel drive, and massive interior legroom.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- BMC-B-Series-1.8L: 1.8L (1798cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 63.0 kW / 134.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- 1800 Saloon: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=4-speed manual, AUD $2340-$2550, Fuel=9.2L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* 1800 Saloon | Sedan | BMC-B-Series-1.8L | 4-speed manual | FWD | 63.0kW/134.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: Mk-II (Mk II Austin 1800 & Utility) [1968-1971]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 2-door coupe utility | ANCAP: None
Introduction of the world-exclusive Australian-designed Austin 1800 Utility, upright rear tail fins, twin-carburettor 1800 'S' saloon, and optional Borg-Warner 35 automatic.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- BMC-B-Series-1.8L-MkII: 1.8L (1798cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 65.0 kW / 137.0 Nm
- BMC-B-Series-1.8S-TwinSU: 1.8L (1798cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 72.0 kW / 144.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Austin 1800 Utility: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=4-speed manual, AUD $2190-$2390, Fuel=9.5L/100km
- Austin 1800 'S' Saloon: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=4-speed manual, AUD $2690-$2890, Fuel=9.6L/100km

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Factory Configurations:

* Austin 1800 Utility | Coupe Utility | BMC-B-Series-1.8L-MkII | 4-speed manual | FWD | 65.0kW/137.0Nm
* Austin 1800 'S' Saloon | Sedan | BMC-B-Series-1.8S-TwinSU | 4-speed manual | FWD | 72.0kW/144.0Nm